PROPOSAL

Supplier Integrated Management System (SIMS)

Solution Assessment, Conceptual Design and Implementation Planning Consulting Services

Submitted to

Ajinomoto Philippines Corporation (APC)

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Submitted by

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1. Transmittal Note

Durvah IT Consulting is pleased to submit this proposal in response to Ajinomoto Philippines Corporation's (APC) Request for Proposal for Supplier Integrated Management System (SIMS) Solution Assessment, Conceptual Design and Implementation Planning Consulting Services. We understand this engagement is a critical planning and design stage of APC's Roadmap 2030 digitalization agenda, intended to prepare APC for a well-governed FY27 implementation of a centralized supplier lifecycle management platform.

Durvah IT Consulting brings deep, hands-on experience in procurement technology advisory, SAP S/4HANA-centric integration design, and supplier management platform selection across SAP Ariba, Ivalua, Zycus and comparable solutions. We propose an independent, evidence-based assessment approach that validates APC's existing requirements, benchmarks the market objectively, and delivers a conceptual design and implementation roadmap that APC management can confidently act on.

This proposal presents our understanding of APC's requirements, our proposed scope of work, methodology, team, and a detailed 16-week execution timeline aligned to APC's FY26 planning calendar (August to November 2026), culminating in a Business Case and Executive Management Presentation.

We look forward to the opportunity to partner with APC on this important initiative.

2. Executive Summary

APC currently manages supplier onboarding, procurement collaboration, performance management, quality issue management, audit/compliance, and risk & sustainability monitoring through a fragmented mix of SAP S/4HANA, Excel, email, shared drives, and standalone tools. This fragmentation limits visibility, slows approvals, and increases compliance and audit risk as APC's requirements and regulatory expectations grow.

APC has already defined its future-state business requirements and target capabilities for a Supplier Integrated Management System (SIMS) which is scalable, easy configurable, customizable to APC future needs and AI enabled. Durvah IT Consulting's role is not to re-invent these requirements, but to independently validate them, assess the solution landscape (SAP Ariba, Ivalua, Zycus and any other platform that suits APC requirement– The procurement application to be shortlisted will be identified after understanding the APC current processes) against APC's specific functional, technical and integration needs, and translate the outcome into a conceptual architecture, phased roadmap, and budgetary business case that is ready for MANCOM approval.

Our proposed engagement is structured into four phases delivered over 16 weeks (approximately 3.5–4 months), directly aligned to APC's own FY26 project schedule for “Solution Assessment, Business Case Development & Budget Validation” (August – November 2026):

- Phase 1 — Mobilization & Requirements Validation
- Phase 2 — Conceptual Solution Design & Architecture
- Phase 3 — Solution Assessment & Vendor Evaluation
- Phase 4 — Roadmap, Business Case & Executive Recommendation

The engagement concludes with a Board/MANCOM-ready business case, a recommended platform and implementation strategy, a phased implementation roadmap, and budgetary cost estimates — positioning APC to proceed confidently into implementation vendor sourcing in FY27.

3. Understanding of APC's Requirements

3.1 Current State (AS-IS)

APC's supplier-related activities are currently executed through SAP S/4HANA (ERP, procurement, planning, master data), Jedox (production planning, with procurement planning currently inactive), Infor WMS (warehousing), an email platform (manual notifications), and Microsoft Office (manual reporting, scheduling and supplier monitoring). Key processes such as supplier onboarding, audit tracking, performance reporting, KPI dashboards, vendor commitment, delivery scheduling, and corrective action (CAR) issuance are largely manual, spreadsheet-based, or disconnected from the core ERP transaction flow.

3.2 Target State (TO-BE)

APC envisions a centralized Supplier Integrated Management System comprising: a Supplier Management Platform, Supplier Portal, Workflow & Approval Engine, Analytics & Reporting Layer, Document Management Repository, Risk & Compliance Management Module, and native integration with SAP S/4HANA (PR/PO and master data), Jedox (planning and delivery scheduling), Infor WMS (ASN and warehouse transactions), and a Laboratory/Quality Management System (LIMS/QMS) for quality and compliance data. If required, the consolidation of procurement functions across systems.

3.3 Functional Scope Confirmed by APC

APC's target capabilities span eight functional domains, which Durvah will use as the baseline for requirements validation and solution scoring:

- Supplier Qualification & Master Data Management (onboarding, accreditation, certifications/licenses, pricing database)
- Procurement, Materials Planning & Contract Management (allocation, PO visibility, delivery collaboration, ASN, contract repository)
- Supplier Performance Evaluation (scorecards, benchmarking, development planning)
- Analytics & Reporting (spend/price analytics, compliance reporting, KPI dashboards, DIO/DPO monitoring)
- Communication & Collaboration (supplier portal, secure document exchange, messaging, workflow collaboration)
- Quality Management (NC & CAR management, supplier quality monitoring, quality reporting)
- Supplier Audit & Compliance Management (audit planning/scheduling, findings management, closure monitoring)
- Risk & Sustainability (risk assessment, segmentation, ESG monitoring, business continuity assessment), plus Security & Accessibility (RBAC, e-signatures, approvals, audit trail)

3.4 Key Success Factors

Based on our review of the RFP, Durvah has identified the following as critical to a successful outcome, and has built them explicitly into our scope and approach below:

- Requirements must be validated against real process pain points, not just documented on paper — this requires structured stakeholder workshops, not desk review alone.
- Solution evaluation must be objective and evidence-based, using a weighted scoring model and live vendor demonstrations against APC-specific scenarios.

- Integration feasibility with SAP S/4HANA, Jedox, Infor WMS and LIMS/QMS must be technically validated early, since this drives both architecture and cost.
- The business case and budgetary estimates must be defensible enough to withstand MANCOM scrutiny and support the February 2027 budget approval milestone.
- Change management and data governance considerations must be addressed at the design stage, not deferred to implementation.

4. Scope of Work

Durvah IT Consulting proposes to execute the following scope of work, organized into four phases. Each phase includes the RFP's requested deliverables plus the critical execution steps we consider necessary for a defensible, implementation-ready outcome.

4.1 Phase 1 — Mobilization & Requirements Validation (Weeks 1–4)

Objective: Establish project governance and independently validate APC's documented requirements against actual business pain points.

Key activities

1. Project kickoff, governance setup, and confirmation of stakeholder RACI, communication cadence, and escalation path.
2. Review of APC's existing requirements documentation, AS-IS architecture, and functional scope as the baseline for validation.
3. Structured stakeholder workshops with Procurement, Planning, Quality, IT, and Finance to walk through current pain points and confirm future-state priorities.
4. Process walkthroughs and data gathering for supplier onboarding, PO/ASN flow, quality NC/CAR handling, audit management, and reporting.
5. Gap and risk identification: functional gaps, data quality/ownership issues, and optimization opportunities.
6. Requirements prioritization (MoSCoW) and sign-off with APC stakeholders.

Phase 1 deliverables

- Requirements Validation and Gap Assessment Report
- Confirmed & Prioritized Functional Requirements Register
- Stakeholder Workshop Summary and Sign-off

4.2 Phase 2 — Conceptual Solution Design & Architecture (Weeks 5–8)

Objective: Translate the recommended platform direction into a conceptual future-state process, solution, and integration design.

Key activities

1. Design future-state business process architecture for each functional domain (qualification, procurement collaboration, performance, quality, audit, risk/ESG).

2. Develop high-level solution and integration architecture covering SAP S/4HANA (PR/PO, master data), Jedox (planning/delivery), Infor WMS (ASN/warehouse), LIMS/QMS (quality/compliance), and notification/email touchpoints.
3. Define the Supplier Portal experience, role-based access model, and security & governance framework (RBAC, e-signatures, approval workflows, audit trail logging).
4. Define data governance and master data ownership model between SIMS and SAP S/4HANA.
5. Validate the conceptual architecture with APC IT and business stakeholders through a structured design review workshop.

Phase 2 deliverables

- Conceptual Solution Design Document
- Current-State Assessment and Future-State Architecture Recommendation
- High-Level Solution and Integration Architecture Design
- Security & Governance Framework

4.3 Phase 3 — Solution Assessment & Vendor Evaluation (Weeks 9–12)

Objective: Independently evaluate SAP Ariba, Ivalua, Zycus or any other procurement application most suited to APC requirement.

Key activities

1. Develop a weighted solution evaluation framework covering functional fit, integration capability, scalability, user experience, total cost of ownership, vendor roadmap, and support capability.
2. Issue a structured Request for Information (RFI) / scenario brief to shortlisted vendors (SAP Ariba, Ivalua, Zycus, and up to two additional applicable platforms as agreed with APC).
3. Facilitate vendor demonstration sessions scripted around APC-specific scenarios (supplier onboarding, PO/ASN collaboration, NC/CAR workflow, audit management, dashboards).
4. Technical integration feasibility assessment against SAP S/4HANA, Jedox, Infor WMS, and LIMS/QMS.
5. Total cost of ownership modeling (licensing, implementation, integration, support) for each shortlisted platform.
6. Score, rank, and validate findings with APC's IT and Procurement leadership.

Phase 3 deliverables

- Solution Assessment Matrix and Vendor Comparison Report
- Vendor Demonstration Summary and Scenario Scorecards
- Recommended Platform Evaluation Report (shortlist with rationale)

4.4 Phase 4 — Roadmap, Business Case & Executive Recommendation (Weeks 13–16)

Objective: Package the assessment and design into an implementation roadmap and business case ready for management approval.

Key activities

1. Develop a phased implementation roadmap aligned with APC's FY27 go-live target (August 2027), sequencing quick wins, core rollout, and stabilization.

2. Develop budgetary cost estimates for implementation (licensing, implementation services, integration, change management, internal resourcing).
3. Document implementation risks, assumptions, and dependencies, including data migration, integration, and change management considerations.
4. Prepare the implementation readiness assessment, including APC's internal resourcing and governance requirements.
5. Prepare and deliver the executive management presentation and business case recommendation.
6. Incorporate one round of feedback from APC leadership and finalize all deliverables.

Phase 4 deliverables

- Phased Implementation Roadmap aligned with APC's FY27 implementation target
- Budgetary Cost Estimates for implementation planning and approval
- Implementation Risks, Assumptions, and Dependencies Assessment
- Implementation Readiness Assessment
- Executive Management Presentation and Business Case Recommendation

4.5 Optional Extension Services (available on request, outside base scope)

- Vendor Selection Support during the implementation vendor sourcing stage (Nov 2026 – Mar 2027)
- RFP Refinement and drafting support for the Implementation Phase RFP
- Business Case Enhancement Support ahead of MANCOM presentations
- Implementation Planning Workshop Support (blueprinting readiness)

5. Critical Steps to Execute This Type of Engagement

Based on Durvah's experience delivering similar procurement and supplier-management transformation assessments, the following execution disciplines are embedded throughout our scope to reduce delivery risk and ensure the outcome is actionable:

5.1 Governance and stakeholder alignment

- Establish a joint Steering Committee (APC Procurement, IT, and Durvah leads) with a bi-weekly checkpoint cadence.
- Appoint a single APC Project Sponsor and Business Owner per functional domain to avoid conflicting requirements.
- Agree a formal change-control process for any scope changes identified during validation.

5.2 Evidence-based requirements validation

- Validate requirements through direct process walkthroughs and workshops, not desk review of documents alone.
- Trace every functional requirement to a business owner and a measurable pain point or KPI.

5.3 Objective, structured solution evaluation

- Use a weighted, transparent scoring model agreed with APC before vendor demonstrations begin, to prevent bias in the final recommendation.
- Script vendor demonstrations around APC's own scenarios rather than standard vendor sales demos.

- Independently validate vendor integration claims with APC's SAP Basis/PI-PO and IT integration team.

5.4 Architecture and data governance discipline

- Define data ownership and master data governance (single source of truth) between SIMS and SAP S/4HANA before finalizing the integration architecture.
- Design the security and access model around least-privilege and segregation-of-duties principles from the outset.

5.5 Change management and readiness

- Assess organizational and supplier readiness (internal capacity, supplier digital maturity) as part of the implementation readiness assessment.
- Build a stakeholder communication and change-readiness plan into the roadmap, not as an afterthought during implementation.

5.6 Business case defensibility

- Benchmark budgetary estimates against comparable market implementations to withstand MANCOM scrutiny.
- Present the business case with clearly stated assumptions, exclusions, and sensitivities so APC can make an informed, low-risk decision.

6. Approach & Methodology

Durvah IT Consulting applies a structured, phase-gated methodology purpose-built for platform assessment and conceptual design engagements. Each phase closes with a formal sign-off gate before proceeding, ensuring APC retains full visibility and control over direction and findings.

Phase	Approach	Primary Techniques
1. Mobilization & Requirements Validation	Validate documented requirements through direct engagement with business owners	Kickoff workshop, process walkthroughs, MoSCoW prioritization, gap analysis
2. Conceptual Design & Architecture	Translate requirements and platform direction into a validated future-state design	Process architecture mapping, integration design workshops, security/governance design
3. Solution Assessment & Vendor Evaluation	Score shortlisted platforms objectively against a weighted, APC-specific framework	RFI/scenario briefs, scripted vendor demos, TCO modeling, weighted scorecards
4. Roadmap & Business Case	Package findings into an implementation-ready, MANCOM-defensible business case	Roadmap sequencing, budgetary estimation, risk/assumption logging, executive presentation

Throughout the engagement, Durvah will maintain a single shared workspace (requirements register, RAID log, and decision log) accessible to APC stakeholders, and will issue a weekly status update summarizing progress, decisions needed, and upcoming activities.

7. Team Composition

Durvah IT Consulting will deploy a dedicated, cross-functional team for the duration of the engagement, supplemented by domain specialists as needed during solution assessment.

Role	Responsibility	Approx. Involvement
Project Manager	Day-to-day delivery management, workplan, status reporting, risk/issue tracking	Full-time, all phases
Solution Architect	Solution assessment framework, scoring, conceptual solution & security design	Full-time, all Phases
Integration Architect	SAP S/4HANA, Jedox, Infor WMS and LIMS/QMS integration feasibility & architecture	Part-time, all Phases
Procurement / Supplier Management SME	Requirements validation, functional scope, process design, vendor scenario scripting	Full-time, all Phases
Business Analyst	Workshop facilitation, documentation, requirements register, deliverable drafting	Full-time, all phases

APC Participation Requirements

To deliver this engagement within the proposed 16-week timeline, Durvah requires the following from APC:

- A designated Project Sponsor and functional business owners available for workshops (estimated 4–6 hours/week).
- Access to existing requirements documentation, process documents, and relevant system/integration documentation (SAP S/4HANA, Jedox, Infor WMS, LIMS/QMS).
- IT/Basis and integration resources available for technical validation sessions during Phase 2 and Phase 3.
- Timely review and feedback on draft deliverables (target 3–5 business days per review cycle).
- Coordination support to schedule vendor demonstration sessions and stakeholder workshops.

8. Project Timeline & Milestones

Durvah proposes a 16-week (approximately 3.5–4 month) engagement, aligned with APC's own FY26 schedule for "Solution Assessment, Business Case Development & Budget Validation" (August 2026 – November 2026), enabling APC to proceed to Implementation Vendor Sourcing in line with the RFP's overall project plan.

During the course of the project, Solution Architect and Procurement SME shall be onsite in Ajinomoto head office for the duration of 2 months for critical discussions, conducting workshops with key stakeholders and presenting the final report.

8.1 Phase Timeline

Phase	Duration
Phase 1 — Mobilization & Requirements Validation	Weeks 1–4 (4 weeks)
Phase 2 — Conceptual Solution Design & Architecture	Weeks 5–8 (4 weeks)
Phase 3 — Solution Assessment & Vendor Evaluation	Weeks 9–12 (4 weeks)

Phase	Duration
Phase 4 — Roadmap, Business Case & Executive Recommendation	Weeks 13–16 (4 weeks)

8.2 Calendar View

Week	Focus
Wk 1	Kickoff, governance setup, documentation review
Wk 2	Stakeholder workshops (Procurement, Planning, Quality)
Wk 3	Process walkthroughs & data gathering
Wk 4	Gap assessment; Requirements sign-off (Milestone)
Wk 5	Future-state process architecture design
Wk 6	Integration architecture (SAP/Jedox/Infor WMS/LIMS)
Wk 7	Supplier portal, security & governance framework design
Wk 8	Design review workshop; Conceptual Design sign-off (Milestone)
Wk 9	Evaluation framework build; RFI/scenario briefs issued
Wk 10	Vendor briefing & preparation sessions
Wk 11	Vendor demonstrations (SAP Ariba, Ivalua, Zycus, +1)
Wk 12	Scoring, TCO modeling; Solution Assessment Matrix (Milestone)
Wk 13	Implementation roadmap sequencing
Wk 14	Budgetary cost estimation; risk/assumption log
Wk 15	Business case drafting; internal QA review
Wk 16	Executive presentation; final sign-off (Milestone)

8.3 Key Milestones

Milestone	Target
Engagement kickoff	Week 1
Requirements Validation & Gap Assessment sign-off	Week 4
Conceptual Solution Design sign-off	Week 8
Solution Assessment Matrix & Vendor Shortlist complete	Week 12
Draft Roadmap & Budgetary Estimates issued	Week 14
Final Business Case & Executive Presentation delivered	Week 16
Supports APC Budget Finalization milestone	November 2026
Supports APC MANCOM Approval Presentation (Budget)	February 8, 2027

9. Summary of Deliverables

Phase	Deliverables
1. Mobilization & Requirements Validation	Requirements Validation and Gap Assessment Report; Confirmed & Prioritized Requirements Register; Workshop Summary & Sign-off
2. Conceptual Design & Architecture	Conceptual Solution Design Document; Current-State Assessment & Future-State Architecture Recommendation; High-Level Solution & Integration Architecture; Security & Governance Framework
3. Solution Assessment & Vendor Evaluation	Solution Assessment Matrix and Vendor Comparison Report; Vendor Demonstration Summary & Scorecards; Recommended Platform Evaluation Report
4. Roadmap & Business Case	Phased Implementation Roadmap; Budgetary Cost Estimates; Implementation Risks/Assumptions/Dependencies Assessment; Implementation Readiness Assessment; Executive Management Presentation & Business Case

10. Assumptions, Dependencies & Exclusions

Assumptions

- APC's existing requirements documentation is substantially complete and will be made available at project kickoff.
- Vendor demonstrations are conducted remotely unless otherwise agreed; any on-site vendor sessions may affect timeline and cost.
- Up to 4 solution vendors (SAP Ariba, Ivalua, Zycus, or any other procurement application that suits APC requirements) will be assessed under base scope; assessing additional vendors is treated as a scope change.
- This engagement covers assessment, design and planning only — it does not include software licensing, implementation, configuration, or build activities.

Dependencies

- Timely availability of APC business and IT stakeholders for workshops and validation sessions.
- Timely vendor responses to RFI/scenario briefs and availability for demonstration scheduling.
- Access to relevant SAP S/4HANA, Jedox, Infor WMS and LIMS/QMS technical documentation for integration assessment.

Exclusions

- Software licensing fees, implementation services, and vendor selection/negotiation are outside base scope (available as an optional extension per Section 4.5).
- Detailed technical build specifications, data migration execution, and testing are part of the FY27 implementation phase, not this engagement.

11. Commercials

The project shall be executed on a fixed cost basis for the deliverables defined in the scope.

Supplier Integrated Management System Solution Assessment, Conceptual Design and Implementation Planning Services	**USD 135,000**

The project fees include professional fees, onsite expenses like flight, accommodation, local transport, visa etc, which shall be invoiced based on the following project milestone:

Milestone	%	Amount
On Project awarding & Kick-off	10%	USD 13,500
Phase-1 Delivery	20%	USD 27,000
Phase-2 Delivery	25%	USD 33,750
Phase-3 Delivery	25%	USD 33,750
Phase-4 Delivery	20%	USD 27,000
Total	**100%**	**USD 135,000**

12. Budgetary Implementation Cost for Procurement Platform

The outcome of the APC procurement process study, including the conceptualization and implementation planning exercise, will be the evaluation of the proposed procurement solution and an estimate of the implementation cost..

- Following is the tentative implementation cost of a Procurement platform for APC.
- The implementation cost may vary depending on the final scope arrived at, after the conceptualization phase of this project.
- The license cost can only be determined upon completion of the study phase, as it depends on factors such as the selected procurement solution, the required modules, the number of users, customizations required, and other ATC specific requirements.

Tentative Implementation Cost of a Procurement solution for APC	**USD 425,000 to USD 550,000**
Tentative Implementation Timeline	**7 – 10 months**

13. Why Durvah IT Consulting

- Independent, vendor-neutral advisory — Durvah holds no referral arrangements with SAP Ariba, Ivalua, or Zycus, ensuring an unbiased recommendation.
- More than 10 years of experience in Procurement platform consulting, advisory and implementation.
- Proven procurement and supplier-management transformation methodology, purpose-built for assessment-to-business-case engagements.
- Deep SAP S/4HANA integration expertise, directly relevant to APC's core ERP-centric architecture.
- A senior, hands-on delivery team combining solution architecture, integration, and procurement domain expertise.

- A track record of delivering MANCOM/board-ready business cases that translate directly into funded implementation programs.

14. Durvah IT Consulting — Proposal Contact

We welcome the opportunity to clarify any aspect of this proposal or present our approach to APC's evaluation committee.

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